YICHEN WANG

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EDUCATION

Georgetown University, Washington, DC — September 2025 – August 2027 (expected)
Research Scholar, McDonough School of Business

Shanghai Jiao Tong University, China — 2021 – March 2027 (expected)
Ph.D. in Finance, Shanghai Advanced Institute of Finance (AACSB-accredited)

Shandong University, China — 2017 – 2021
B.A. in Finance, *Summa Cum Laude*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Corporate Finance, Household Finance, and Real Estate

REFERENCES

Xiaoyun Yu
SAIF, SJTU
xyyu@saif.sjtu.edu.cn

Francesco D'Acunto
Georgetown
francesco.dacunto@georgetown.edu

Janet Gao
Georgetown
janet.gao@georgetown.edu

Xiao Zhao
SAIF, SJTU
xiaozhao@saif.sjtu.edu.cn

PUBLICATIONS

Curse of low-skilled emigration on human capital formation: Evidence from the migration surge of the 2000s [DOI]
with Sam Hak Kan Tang and Yong Wang
- ***World Development***, 2025 (**ABDC A***; a leading development economics journal)
- **Highlights**: Exploiting the surge of low-skilled migration to OECD countries in the 2000s, we show that the prospect of low-skilled emigration discourages human capital formation in sending countries, reducing schooling and tertiary attainment—an effect concentrated in middle- and high-income countries.

WORKING PAPERS

1. **Firm Trade Resilience and Credit Access** [SSRN]
   - **Job Market Paper**
   - **Best Poster Award Finalist**, 13th ABFER Annual Conference
   - Travel Grant, 2027 AFA Annual Meeting
   - Travel Grant, 2nd HKU Next-Gen Finance PhD Workshop
   - **Abstract**: This study examines how firms navigate trade disruptions and how credit access shapes their response. I obtain identification through anti-dumping investigations against Chinese exports, which target a particular product in a particular market. Using customs data matched with firm tax records, I find hit firms reduce exports of the targeted product to the initiating market, but redirect it toward other markets and keep their other products in the affected market, while retreating from products and markets not subject to the shock. Their export revenue increases, but profitability does not, due to rising costs of production, sales, and financing. Exploiting the staggered rollout of the VAT rebate loan program across Chinese cities, I find that hit firms with loan access maintain the affected export relationship, drop fewer unrelated export lines, and face no rise in the cost of debt. These findings suggest that credit access cushions adverse tariff shocks.
2. **Bank Ownership as a Political Instrument: Evidence from Chinese Local Governments** [SSRN]
   with Naide Ye
   - **Revise and Resubmit (R&R)** at ***Review of Finance*** (**ABDC A*, FT50**)
   - Dissertation Chapter 2, developed from my Second-year Summer Paper

– **Abstract**: We study how local governments use equity stakes in banks as a political and fiscal instrument to expand off-budget credit. We develop a novel city-bank-year measure of Chinese local government ownership from banks' shareholder registries and link it to transaction-level borrowing by local government financing vehicles (LGFVs). We find that a one-standard-deviation increase in a local government's ownership stake in a bank raises that bank's credit to local government borrowers by 11%. We exploit a regulatory reform that forced private shareholders to unwind bank holdings to support a causal interpretation. This effect is stronger when political competition is intense, officials near the end of their terms, and fiscal constraints are tighter. Greater local-government ownership also makes LGFV investment more responsive to industry performance, yet these projects are more likely to fail, indicating that ownership directs credit to attractive industries at the cost of project quality.

3. **Political Ideology and Durable Spending** [SSRN] [CEPR]
with Yongqiang Chu, Francesco D'Acunto, Janet Gao, and Roman Wang
   – **Semifinalist, Best Paper Award, 2026 FMA Annual Conference**
   – CEPR Discussion Paper No. 22056 (2026)
   – **Abstract**: We study political ideology as a driver of heterogeneous durable spending. Research in psychology suggests that conservatives' personality traits lead them to focus on the investment properties of durables, whereas liberals focus on consumption value. Combining U.S. voter registration records with housing transactions, which capture both consumption and investment motives, we show that conservatives transact more frequently, especially in secondary properties, which do not necessarily provide any consumption value. Conditional on transacting, conservatives more often trade down and realize capital gains, while liberals trade up and increase housing consumption. Conservatives' transactions, but not liberals', respond more strongly to financial incentives: interest rates, the opportunity cost of housing investments relative to equities, and house-price appreciation. Within households, ideology does not combine linearly: mixed-ideology couples transact less than ideologically homogeneous ones of either color, and their choices align more closely with the man's ideology.

PRESENTATIONS & DISCUSSIONS

Conference and Workshop Presentations

2027 American Finance Association (AFA) Annual Meeting (Poster Session)†

2026 SFS Cavalcade Asia-Pacific†; Financial Management Association (FMA) Annual Meeting; 66th Annual Southern Finance Association Meeting†; Asian Bureau of Finance and Economic Research (ABFER) 13th Annual Conference (Poster Session); China Financial Research Conference (Tsinghua PBC School of Finance); Eighth China International Conference in Macroeconomics

2025 Dishui Lake International Conference in Finance (Shanghai University of Finance and Economics); 8th International Conference of China and Development Studies

2024 8th China Center for Economic Research (CCER) Summer Institute, Peking University

2023 11th Hong Kong Economic Association Biennial Conference*

Seminar Presentations

2026 Georgetown University (EGSO Seminar)

2022 University of Western Australia (Economics)*; Australian National University (Crawford School)*

† scheduled. * presented by coauthor.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Georgetown University

Teaching Assistant

FINC-3101 Corporate Valuation (Undergraduate) Fall 2026

Shanghai Advanced Institute of Finance (SAIF)

Teaching Assistant *All courses taught in English*

Principles of Finance, Corporate Finance (MBA, Master of Finance) Fall 2023–Spring 2025

Financial Literacy (Undergraduate) Spring 2024
Real Estate Finance (MBA) Summer 2023
Advanced Business Analytics, Product Pricing Strategy (MBA) 2021–2022
Asset Management in Practice (MBA) 2021–2022

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AlixPartners July 2026 – Present
PhD Economist (Contract)

- Developed the methodology for the firm's flagship **Disruptive Index**, a proprietary composite index of corporate financial performance and macro-financial indicators, formalizing the framework into a rigorous measurement model following OECD guidance.
- Evaluated candidate indicators and tested normalization, weighting, and aggregation methods (z-scores, PCA/factor models).
- Prepared methodology documentation and executive-ready deliverables for non-technical stakeholders.

REFEREE ACTIVITY

Ad Hoc Referee

Journal of Corporate Finance (ABDC A*), *Journal of Banking & Finance* (ABDC A*), *Pacific-Basin Finance Journal* (ABDC A)

Conference Referee

ICGS Conference 2026 (HEC Montréal)

GRANTS AND AWARDS

2027 AFA Travel Grant
2026 Best Poster Award Finalist, 13th ABFER Annual Conference; Travel Grant, 2nd HKU Next-Gen Finance PhD Workshop
2024 Excellent Teaching Assistant, SAIF
2021– Ph.D. Fellowship, SAIF

SKILLS

Programming: Stata and Python
Language: English and Mandarin Chinese